The rainforest is an area of dense forest that is home to close to fifty percent of the world's species. The basic functions of the Earth rely on the rich ecosystem of tropical rainforests. Our rainforests are very important because they provide homes to many plants and animals. This ecosystem helps the world's climate maintain balance, and protects against many natural disasters such as floods, drought, and erosion. Within the many layers of the rainforest lie resources for new medicines and food. There are also tribal people who live in the rainforest that we can learn from. The preservation of this land is vital to balance the world's ecosystem.

The Rainforest

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

rainforest - area characterized by thick trees and vegetation, lots of rain, and many plants and animals

ecosystem - a collection of living things in the environment that function as a unit

preservation - to keep safe from harm or injury

canopy - upper part of the trees in the rainforest

ethnobotany - the study of how people use plants to treat and cure illness

shaman - medicine man or spiritual leader in tribal societies

global warming - an increase in the earth's atmospheric temperature

Rainforests are found near the equator of the Earth. The warm and wet climate allows many different plants to grow that are home to numerous species of animals. All animal groups can be found in the rainforest. These include mammals, like the monkey; reptiles, such as the snake; and even amphibians, birds, and fish. The largest population of creatures present in the rainforest is a variety of insects. Beautiful flowers, like the orchid, help attract these insects. Since the canopy of the rainforest is so thick, competition for light on the ground has caused many of the plants to adapt to the environment. In the rainforest, it is common to see plants growing from the sides of trees or from branches.

wet	**insects**	**canopy**
adapted	**mammals**	

Rainforests have a warm and _____ climate.

Reptiles, amphibians, fish, birds, and _____ can be found in the rainforest.

The Rainforest has many different types of _____ and plants that attract them.

Since the ground of the rainforest is so dark, many of the plants have _____,

The thick _____ blocks most light before it reaches the forest floor.

What groups of animals can be found in the rainforest?

a. birds b. reptiles and mammals c. all groups

What is climate in the rainforest?

a. extremely hot b. freezing c. warm and wet

What is so thick that it allows very little light to reach the ground?

a. canopy b. equator c. insects

Many plants will grow on the sides of trees to get sunlight, what have they done?

a. eroded b. adapted c. environment

What groups of animals can be found in the rainforest?

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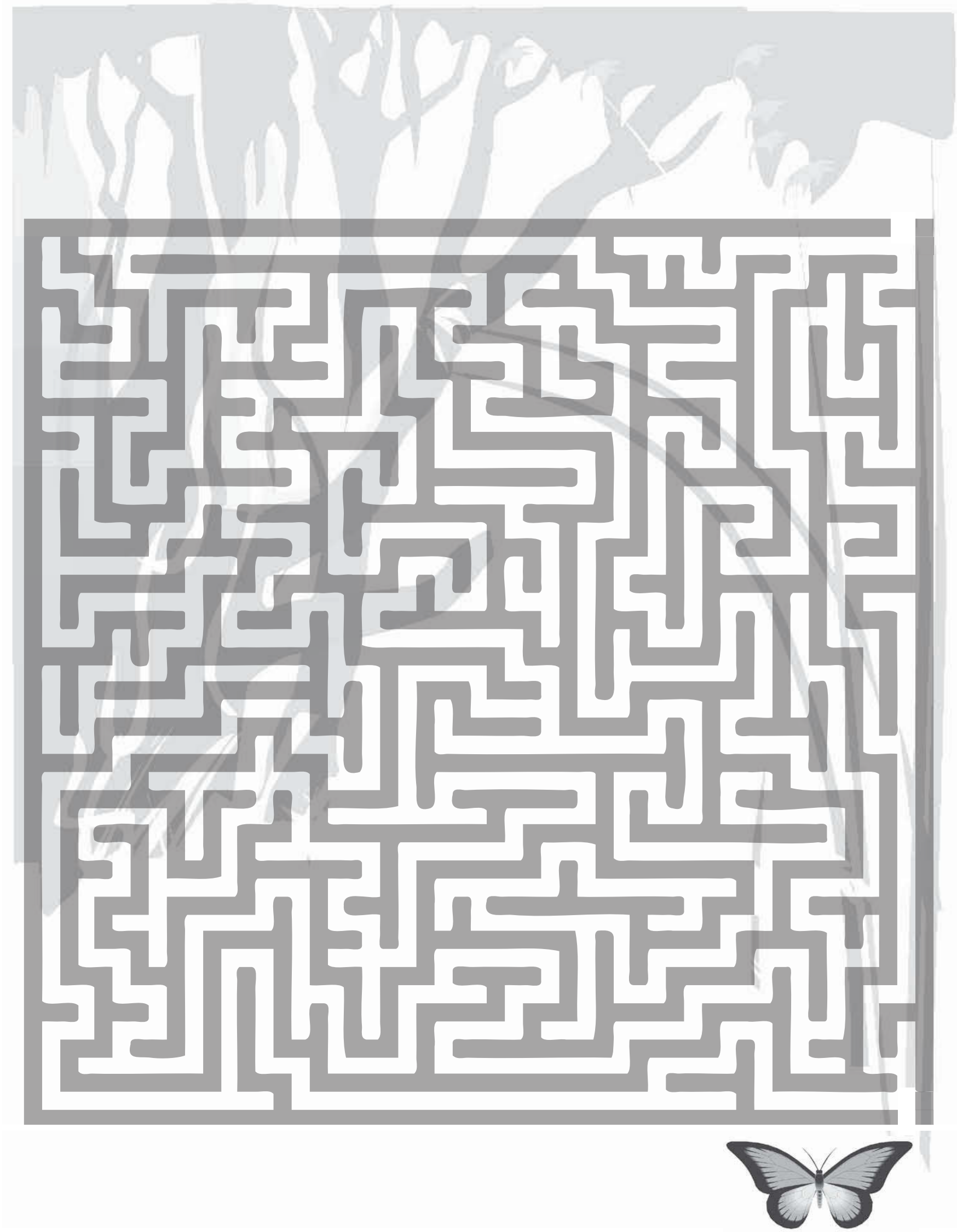


The Rainforest

Help the butterfly reach the canopy.

The rainforest is an important part of our global ecosystem. The lush vegetation helps stabilize the world's climate by absorbing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere. Global warming is believed to be caused by excess carbon dioxide released in the atmosphere. Not only does the rainforest help with the effects of global warming, it also aids in the maintenance of the water cycle. Rainforests play an important role in adding water to the water cycle through transpiration. Transpiration is the process in which leaves release water during photosynthesis. The excess moisture allows the formation of rain clouds, which then release water back into the environment.

global	**water cycle**
atmosphere	**global warming**

The rainforest helps our _____ ecosystem by absorbing carbon dioxide from the _____ . The excess carbon dioxide in the atmosphere is believed to contribute to _____ _____. Through transpiration, the rainforest helps add water to the _____ _____.

Maintaining Balance

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

The rainforest helps stabilize the world's climate.

True False

Vegetation from the rainforest absorbs oxygen.

True False

Transpiration is the process in which leaves release water during photosynthesis.

True False

Global warming is caused by too many animals.

True False

The rainforest aids in the maintenance of the water cycle.

True False

The rainforest helps stabilize the world's climate.

True False

Vegetation from the rainforest absorbs oxygen.

True False

Transpiration is the process in which leaves release water during photosynthesis.

True False

Global warming is caused by too many animals.

True False

The rainforest aids in the maintenance of the water cycle.

True False

RAINFOREST

See how many words you can create using the letters from the word above.

Example: FIN

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

Ethnobotany, the study of how people use native plants to heal the sick and disease-ridden, is one of the most promising aspects of the rainforest. Many prescription drugs used in the U.S are derived from plants. Most importantly, almost seventy percent of plants having cancer fighting characteristics are only found in the rainforest. A Shaman, or medicine man of an indigenous village, has knowledge of natural remedies to cure anything from a spider bite to a tumor. Some of our favorite foods originated in the tropical rainforests, including coffee, vanilla, cinnamon, peanuts, and rice. It is believed there are many others in the depths of the rainforests that are yet to be discovered.

Ethnobotany	**plants**	**cancer**
discover	**Shamans**	**originated**

The study of how people use native plants to heal the sick is know as _____.

Almost seventy percent of anti-_____ drugs come from plants found only in the rainforest.

Medicine men, or _____, use the plants of the rainforest to heal people.

Some of the prescription drugs used in the U.S. come from _____ in the rainforest.

Many of the foods we love _____ in the rainforest. There may be more to _____.

Food and Medicine

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

Ethnobotany ●

● Medicine man

Shaman ●

● Derived from plants in the rainforest

Prescription drugs ●

● Study of plants used to heal

Plants ●

● Some have cancer fighting characteristics

Rainforest ●

● Where many of our favorite foods come from

Food and Medicine

Match the description with the correct answer.

Ethnobotany

Shaman

Prescription drugs

Plants

Rainforest

Medicine man

Derived from plants in the rainforest

Study of plants used to heal

Some have cancer fighting characteristics

Where many of our favorite foods come from

R Z F R O G T S Z T M
N E L T K T N B K E I
R E O E R A R R D I N
P Y W E K L E I K E G
E N E E M L C T A N E
L S R K S I O M A A R
M L G M N R B D C M D
S T S E R O F N I A R
T N K A T G M M C H A
N G P A R E D I P S Z
C A N C E R N E R F I
S Y D E M E R E T T L

Rainforest
Shaman
Lizard
Cancer
Frog

Trees
Gorilla
Medicine
Flower
Botany

Monkey
Snake
Spider
Remedy
Parrot

Maintaining Balance

Complete the Word Search.

There are many tribes of indigenous people living in the rainforest. For example, the Yanomamo tribe of the Amazon has lived in villages for hundreds of years, surviving off of the natural resources of the land. Most of the forest people get all of their necessities, such as food, clothing, and shelter, from the forest. They hunt and gather to provide food for their families. Western civilizations have gained great knowledge about the natural healing abilities of many plants. However, many of these populations are declining due to disease. These diseases are brought by outsiders and include measles and smallpox. Their homes, the rainforests, are also being destroyed.

land	**destruction**	**food**
plants	**shelter**	

Indigenous people of the rainforest have been surviving off the _____ for hundreds of years. They use natural resources to provide themselves with food, clothing, and _____.

These natives do not harm the land they live on, and hunt and gather to get _____.

Western civilization has learned a great deal about natural remedies derived from _____.

Unfortunately, indigenous populations are declining due to disease and _____ of their homes.

What is causing the decline of the indigenous population?

How do the indigenous people get food?

What do the people of the forest use for necessities?

How has Western civilization benefitted from these people?

What is causing the decline of the indigenous population?

Destruction of the rainforest and disease

How do the indigenous people get food?

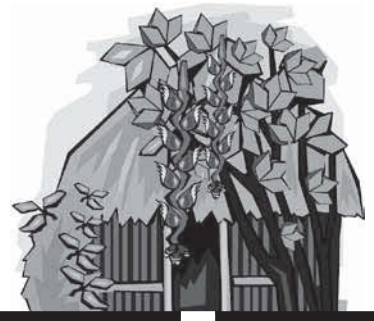
They hunt and gather for their food.

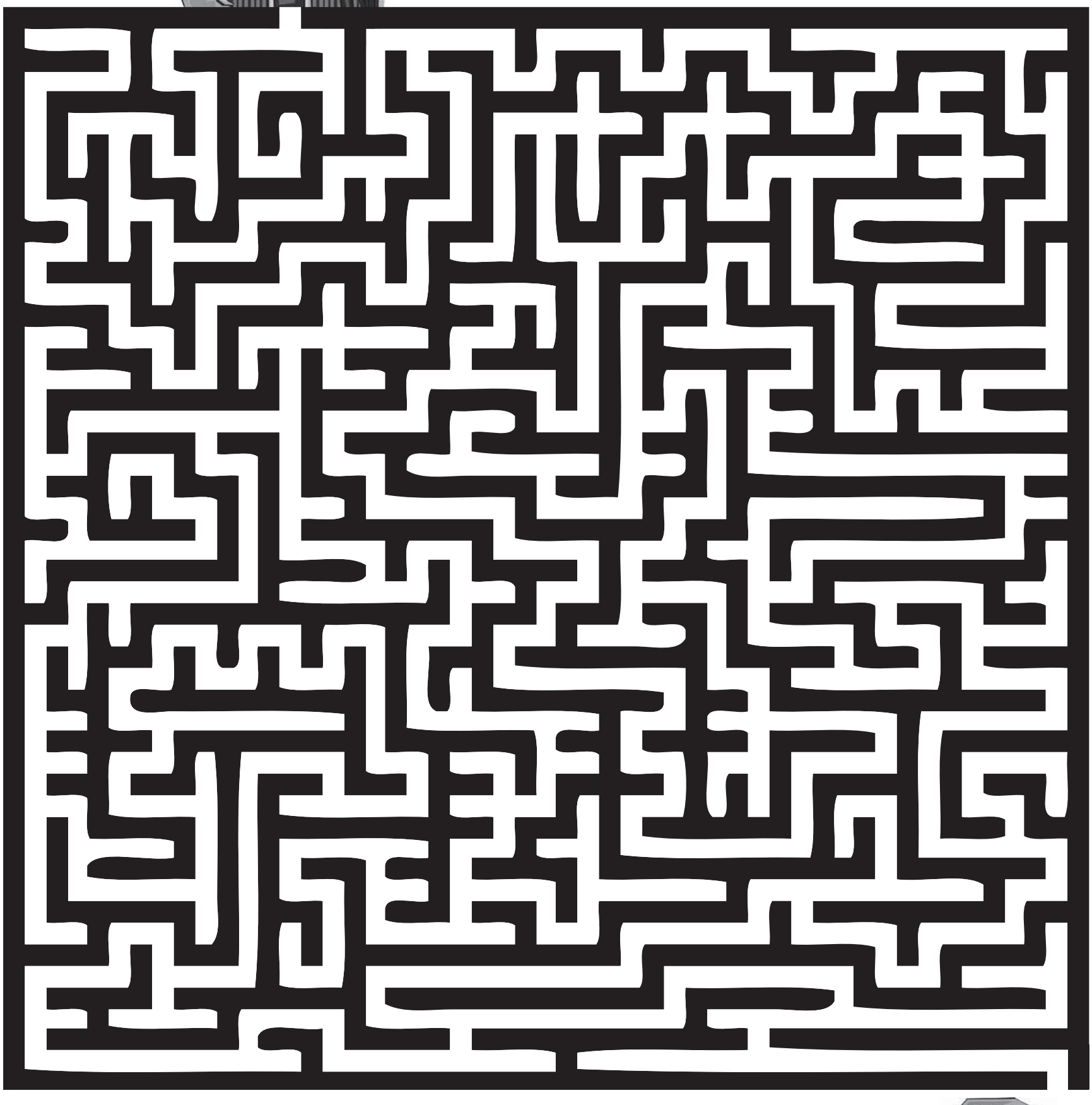
What do the people of the forest use for necessities?

They use natural resources.

How has Western civilization benefitted from these people?

They have learned about medicines and remedies.





People of the Rainforest

Help this boy find his home through the maze.

Since the rainforest is located near the equator, it is never too hot and never gets to freezing temperatures. The average temperature is usually between 75 and 80 degrees Fahrenheit. There is very little evidence of seasons and it rains throughout the year. It rains roughly 1 1/2 inches every week. Each year it rains around 80 inches. This type of climate allows the huge range of species and plants to inhabit the forests.

Climate of the Rainforest

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

animals	**season**	**plants**
rain	**equator**	**year**

The rainforests are located near the _____.

There are no evident _____, and the average temperature is between 75 to 80 degrees.

Roughly 1 1/2 inches of _____ falls each week. This averages to about 80 inches of rain each _____.

This humid climate is the perfect environment for the rainforest's large range of _____ and _____.

Climate of the Rainforest

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

What are the rainforests located near?

Equator North Pole Midwest

What is the climate of the rainforest?

Warm and Wet Cold Dry

What is the average annual rainfall?

16 inches 80 inches 90 inches

What allows many plants and animals to live in the rainforest?

Climate Sunlight Ice

What is a warm and wet climate called?

Humid Arid Polar

Climate of the Rainforest *Circle the correct answer.*

What are the rainforests located near?

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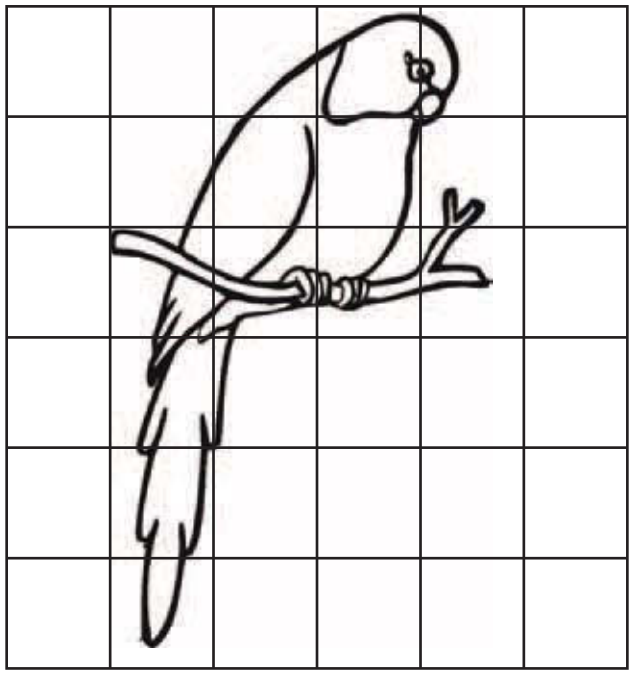

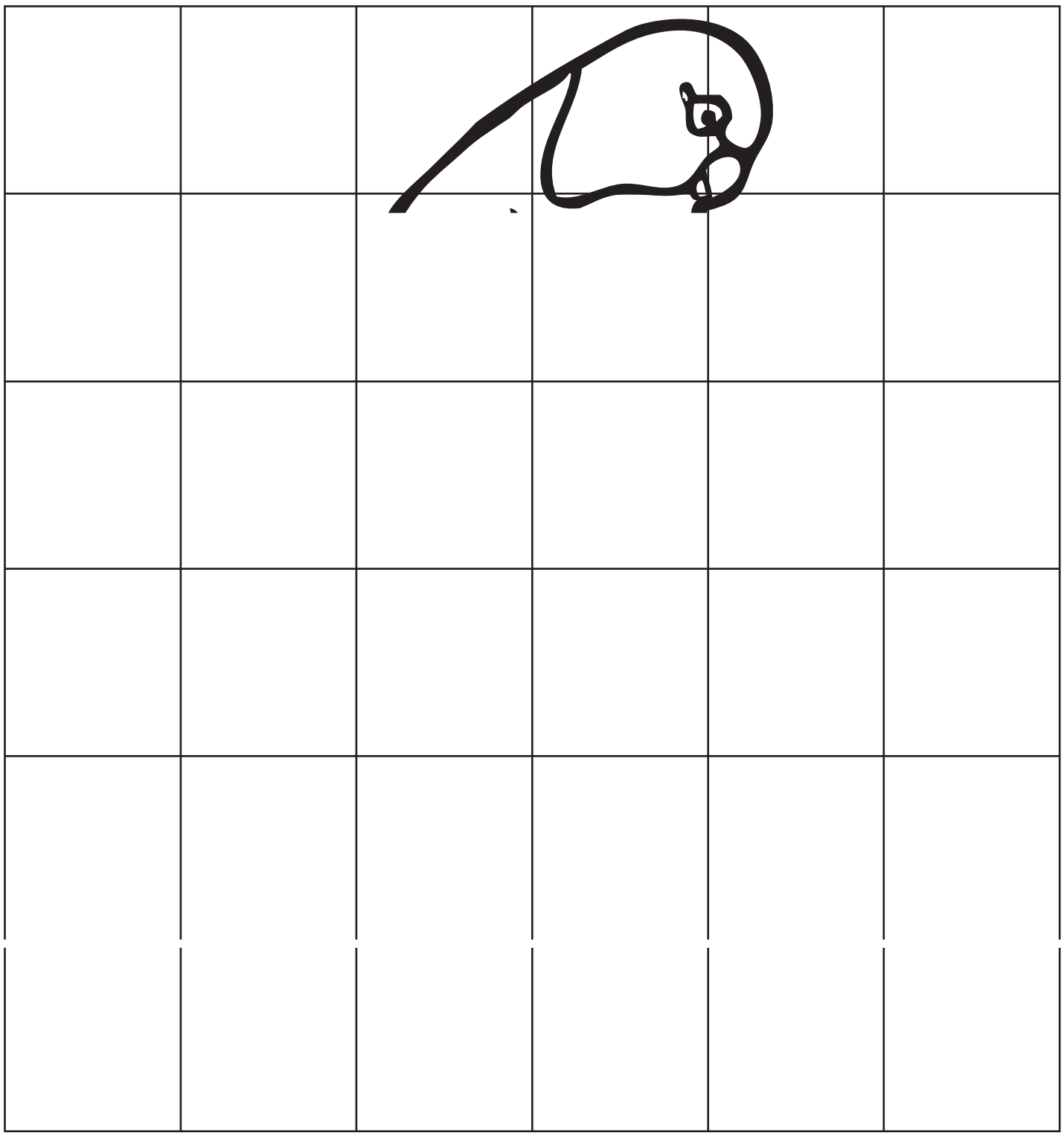

Climate of the Rainforest

Draw the parrot.

Our rainforests are being destroyed at an astonishing rate each year. Much of this is due to logging. These trees are used for flooring, construction and even furniture. Logging is very destructive to the rainforest and risks the disruption of our whole ecosystem if it continues. There are many ways to help save the rainforest. They are as simple as supporting companies that are environmentally friendly. This means the companies use recycling, energy conservation, and support other methods of conservation. Each small contribution helps, and you can even contribute by starting a recycling bin in your home.

Preserving Our Rainforest

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

flooring	**bin**	**conserve**
rainforests	**environmentally**	

Logging is destroying many of our _____.

People use the wood from rainforests for furniture, construction, and _____ .

Every person can help save our rainforest by supporting companies that are _____ friendly.

Environmentally friendly companies recycle, _____ energy, and support other methods of conservation.

You can get a recycling _____ in your own home to become more environmentally friendly.

Preserving Our Rainforest

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

What is causing the most destruction of the rainforests?

_____

What are some ways you can help save the rainforest?

_____

_____

How do you know if a company is environmentally friendly?

_____

Why is it important to keep our rainforests intact?

What is causing the most destruction of the rainforests?

Logging is causing most of the destruction.

What are some ways you can help save the rainforest?

You can recycle, conserve energy, and support environmentally friendly businesses.

How do you know if a company is environmentally friendly?

They recycle, conserve energy, and support conservation methods.

Why is it important to keep our rainforests intact?

The rainforests have an impact on the world's ecosystem.

There are many different kinds of animals in the rainforest.
Some believe there are still many more to be discovered.
Draw a creature they might find in the depths of the rainforest.
Give it a name.

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